Packer's output:

```
$ aws cloudformation deploy --stack-name etherpad-packer \
➥ --template-file packer.yaml
➥ --parameter-overrides AMI=$AMI \
➥ --capabilities CAPABILITY_IAM
```

It will take CloudFormation about 10 minutes to provision all the resources. After that, the command will return. Next, use the following command to get the URL to access the Etherpad application:

```
aws cloudformation describe-stacks --stack-name etherpad-packer \
➥ --query "Stacks[0].Outputs[0].OutputValue" --output text
```

Open the URL of your Etherpad application and create a new pad. Click the settings icon to check the current version of Etherpad as shown in the following listing. The version is `c85ab49`, which is the latest Git commit ID for version 1.8.17.

The CloudFormation template to deploy the Etherpad AMI built by Packer is very similar to that in the previous section, except a parameter allows you to hand over the ID of your Etherpad AMI. You'll find the Packer template to build an AMI for Etherpad at chapter15/packer.yaml in the book's code repository on GitHub at https://github.com/AWSinAction/code3.

Listing 15.9 Handing over the AMI ID to the CloudFormation template

```
# [...]
Parameters:
  AMI:                                                    ①
    Type: 'AWS::EC2::Image::Id'
    Description: 'The AMI ID'
```